Design brief — AwkBeats Prep Station

Document control

Field	Value
Project	AwkBeats Prep Station
Document title	Design Brief
Document ID	ABP-DESIGN
Version	1.0
Status	Final (as shipped)
Last updated	2026-10-21 (UTC)
Author	Cursor Agent, for owner Awkward J
Repo	https://github.com/Awkward8787/awkbeats-prep-station
Branch	`cursor/awkbeats-prep-station-e2e2`
Commit SHA	Recorded in the changelog of the shipping commit that contains this file
Live URL	None. Brand site: https://awkbeats.com
Operator	Awkward J (legal entity UNCONFIRMED)

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1. Brand

Name: AwkBeats. Product: Prep Station. Producer: Awkward J. Site: https://awkbeats.com.

Tagline: none in the product. The top bar subtitle is "Prep Station".

The interface should feel like a studio tool: dark, quiet, gold used for the brand and for the key badge, numbers in a monospace face so BPM columns line up.

Personality, each as a contrast the UI should hold:

- Precise, not playful. BPM is `140.25`, not "about 140".
- Calm, not nightclub. No animated gradients, no strobe on the waveform.
- Direct, not chatty. Buttons say "Write tags to file", not "Let's save your vibe".
- Local, not cloudy. No account avatar, no sync icon.

Audience reminder: a producer at a desk, often for hours. Density is welcome. Decoration is not.

2. Logo and mascot

There is no mascot. No owner-supplied logo file was in the repo. The mark was drawn for this app and is UNCONFIRMED as the official AwkBeats logo (Q-004).

Asset	Path	Use
Source mark	`build/icon.svg`	Rounded rectangle, gold waveform, letters AJ
App icon	`build/icon.png` 1024×1024	electron-builder mac icon
Windows icon	`build/icon.ico`	electron-builder win icon
In-app mark	`BrandMark` in `src/renderer/App.tsx`	32×32 in the top bar

Clear space: keep at least the mark's height empty around it in marketing. Minimum size: 32px in the UI, 1024 source for the installer. Backgrounds: the mark includes its own dark rounded rect, so it can sit on `#0c0d10`. Do not recolor the gold, do not stretch it, do not add a new letterform unless the owner approves.

There is no Open Graph image and no favicon separate from the app icon. Not applicable for a desktop window.

3. Color

Tokens are in `src/renderer/styles.css` on `:root`. Ratios were computed with the WCAG relative-luminance formula on 2026-10-21.

Token	Hex	RGB	Role
`--bg`	`#0c0d10`	12, 13, 16	Window background
`--bg-rail`	`#101114`	16, 17, 20	Top bar, rail, inspector, footer
`--bg-elev`	`#17191e`	23, 25, 30	Inputs, analysis card, buttons
`--bg-elev-2`	`#21242b`	33, 36, 43	Pills, play button
`--bg-active`	`#2a2418`	42, 36, 24	Selected table row
`--line`	`#2c3038`	44, 48, 56	Hairline borders
`--line-strong`	`#3c414b`	60, 65, 75	Button borders
`--text`	`#f4f0e8`	244, 240, 232	Primary text
`--text-dim`	`#b7b1a6`	183, 177, 166	Secondary text
`--text-faint`	`#938d85`	147, 141, 133	Labels, counts, section titles
`--gold`	`#e4b15a`	228, 177, 90	Accent, primary button
`--gold-2`	`#f3d7a4`	243, 215, 164	Gold text, focus

Token	Hex	RGB	Role
`--gold-dim`	`rgba(228,177,90,0.16)`	—	Tag chip fill
`--mint`	`#8ee0b8`	142, 224, 184	Status Ready
`--blue`	`#9eb6f0`	158, 182, 240	Status Leased
`--coral`	`#f09a86`	240, 154, 134	Destructive text
`--violet`	`#d2b0f0`	210, 176, 240	Status Sold
`--danger`	`#ff6d6d`	255, 109, 109	Reserved danger
`--focus`	`#f3d7a4`	243, 215, 164	Focus ring
Table header background	`#12141a`	18, 20, 26	Sticky header, not a token
Primary ink	`#1a1408`	26, 20, 8	Text on gold buttons
Modal surface	`#14161b`	20, 22, 27	Dialogs
Toast surface	`#242017`	36, 32, 23	Toasts

Pair	Ratio	WCAG
`--text` on `--bg`	17.10	AAA
`--text-dim` on `--bg`	9.12	AAA
`--text-faint` on `--bg`	5.68	AA
`--text-faint` on `--bg-rail`	5.52	AA
`--text-faint` on `#12141a`	5.39	AA
`--text-faint` on `--bg-elev`	5.14	AA
`--text-faint` on `--bg-active`	4.50	AA
`--gold` on `--bg`	9.93	AAA
`--gold-2` on `--bg`	13.94	AAA
`#1a1408` on `--gold`	9.36	AAA
`--mint` on `--bg`	12.50	AAA
`--blue` on `--bg`	9.63	AAA
`--coral` on `--bg`	8.95	AAA
`--danger` on `--bg`	7.09	AAA
`--text` on `--bg-active`	13.55	AAA
`--text` on `--bg-elev`	15.47	AAA

Status dots are 8px circles plus the status word. Gold means in progress, mint means ready, blue means leased, violet means sold, faint means idea. The word is always present, so a color-blind producer is not relying on the dot.

`--text-faint` was `#7e786e` during the first screenshots and measured 4.44:1 on `--bg` and 4.02:1 on `--bg-elev`, which misses AA for small text. It was changed to `#938d85` before the shipping commit. Section titles are 11px uppercase, so they need AA, not large-text AA.

4. Typography

Families, self-hosted from `@fontsource/ibm-plex-sans` and `@fontsource/ibm-plex-mono`, SIL Open Font License 1.1. Weights loaded in `src/renderer/main.tsx`: sans 400, 500, 600; mono 500. Fallback: `'Segoe UI', sans-serif` and `ui-monospace, monospace`.

Level	Size	Line height	Tracking	Weight	Where
Body	14px	1.45	0	400	`body`
Brand name	13px	—	0.14em	600	`.brand-name`
Subtitle	11px	—	0.08em	400, uppercase	`.brand-sub`
Section label	11px	—	0.12em	600, uppercase	`.section-label`, rail `h2`
Inspector title	20px	—	0	600	`.inspector-head h3`
Tempo	40px	1	-0.04em	500 mono	`.tempo`
Key	18px	—	0	400	`.key-line`
Table header	11px	—	0.08em	600, uppercase	`.tracks th`
BPM cells	14px	—	0	500 mono	`.mono`
Footer	12px	—	0	400	`.footer`
Empty title	22px	—	0	600	`.empty h2`
Dialog title	18px	—	0	600	`.modal h2`
Button	14px	—	0	400, primary 600	`.btn`

No responsive type scale. The window does not change font size with viewport.

5. Spacing, layout, and grid

The app grid is `60px` top bar, `minmax(0, 1fr)` workspace, `30px` footer. The workspace is `248px`, flexible table, `400px` inspector. Gap in the top bar is 16px. Rail padding is 16px. Table cells are 10px horizontal, row height 44px.

Breakpoint: `max-width: 980px` switches to two columns (see ABP-FLOW). There is no other breakpoint.

Spacing used repeatedly: 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 18px. There is no 8pt token file beyond the CSS itself. The window minimum is 1100×700.

6. Shape and depth

Token	Value	Use
`--radius`	12px	Analysis card
Inputs, buttons, status rows	8px	`.btn`, `.status-item`, fields
Camelot badge	6px	`.camelot`
Pills and chips	99px	`.pill`, `.chip`
Play	99px	`.play`
Modal	16px	`.modal`
Drop overlay	16px	`.drop`
Cover	10px	`.cover`
Toast	10px	`.toast`
`--shadow`	`0 24px 60px rgba(0,0,0,0.45)`	Modal and toast
Focus	2px solid `--focus`, offset 2px	`:focus-visible`
Borders	1px `--line` or `--line-strong`	Panels and inputs

No stickers. No extra outline brand stroke.

7. Components

Code lives in `src/renderer/styles.css` and the TSX files named below.

Component	Anatomy	States	File
Brand button	32px mark, wordmark, subtitle	Default, focus-visible. Hover does not recolor.	`App.tsx`
Search field	Input, sr label	Default, focus	`App.tsx`
Button `.btn`	8×12 padding, 8px radius	Default, hover (gold border), disabled 0.45 opacity	CSS
Primary `.btn-primary`	Gold fill, ink text, weight 600	Hover `--gold-2`, disabled	CSS
Ghost `.btn-ghost`	No fill	Hover border	Footer
Danger `.btn-danger`	Coral text	Default	Remove
Status row	Dot, label, count	Default dim, hover and `.active` elevated	`Sidebar.tsx`
Table	Checkbox, title, BPM, key, genre, status, date	Hover `#191c22`, `.active` `--bg-active`, `.missing` faint text	`TrackTable.tsx`
Camelot badge	Mono code, gold border	Static	CSS `.camelot`
Analysis card	Tempo, key, buttons, waveform SVG	BPM lock disables half, double, input	`Inspector.tsx`
Cover well	Square, cover-size background	Empty faint label, or image	`Inspector.tsx`
Chip	Gold dim pill, remove	Default	Tags
Field	Label 12px dim, control	Error text `.error` in coral 12px	Inspector and dialogs
Modal	Scrim `rgba(0,0,0,0.62)`, panel `#14161b`, width min(520px, 100%), wide min(680px, 100%)	Open	`dialogs.tsx`
Toast	Gold border, max-width 360px, bottom right	Timed 4.2s	`App.tsx`
kbd	Mono, gold-2, 1px border, 2px bottom	Static	Shortcuts

8. Iconography and illustration

The only illustration is the brand mark (waveform plus AJ) and the analysis waveform, which is a gold SVG path of the beat's 160 peaks (stroke `#e4b15a` via `--gold`, width 1.4, no fill). Status uses CSS dots, not an icon font. No third-party icon set.

9. Motion

No entrance animation is defined. Hover and color changes are instant except where the browser defaults a transition; the reduced-motion rule sets `transition: none` and `animation: none` on everything. The drop overlay appears and disappears with state, not a timed animation. There is no celebration effect.

10. Imagery and media

Covers are JPEG. PNG can be read for size (`ImageSize.ts`) and embedded if the bytes are PNG (`ArtworkPayload` allows `image/jpeg` or `image/png`). The crop dialog always writes JPEG. Export sizes are 1500 and 3000. Display size in the inspector is the column width, square, `object-fit` via CSS `background-size: cover`.

Alt text: the cover is decorative next to the beat title, which is a heading. The empty cover says "No cover". There is no separate alt attribute because the well is a div with a background image.

Audio is played through the `beat://` URL. Formats: wav, mp3, aiff, flac.

11. Voice and copy

Tone: adult, brief, specific. Reading level: plain English, short sentences. Use: beat, library, tag, cover, half-time, double-time, Camelot, producer. Avoid: placeholder, lorem, TODO, "simply", "just", "unlock your", emoji, exclamation marks.

Example of the rule already applied: the empty state names the four formats and the two actions (drop or import). It does not say "Your journey starts here."

The ISRC example `US-AWK-26-00001` is a shape sample in the error string. It is not asserted to be a registered code.

12. Accessibility design rules

- Focus ring: 2px `#f3d7a4`, offset 2px, on `:focus-visible` only.
- Contrast minimum: WCAG AA (4.5:1) for text that is not large. The pairs in section 3 meet that after the faint-color change.
- Do not encode status by color alone. The label is printed.
- Keyboard path must cover import, search, analyze, write, and status. It does (ABP-FLOW).
- Reduced motion must remove animation. It does.
- Hit targets: table rows are 44px. The play control is 36px. Rail rows are shorter. Do not shrink the table row.

13. References and inspiration

No external product was copied. The layout (filters, table, inspector) is the usual pattern of a desktop music librarian. What was taken as a principle: dark chrome and a single accent so the Camelot badge and the primary button are the loudest elements. What was not copied: skeuomorphic decks, neon VU meters, purple-on-black "AI" gradients, Inter/system-stack as the only face.

IBM Plex was chosen because the OFL license is compatible with a commercial app and the mono companion matches the sans.

14. Do and don't

Do:

1. Show BPM with two decimal places.
2. Show the key name and the Camelot code together.
3. Keep gold for the brand, the primary button, the Camelot badge, and the waveform.
4. Write button labels as verbs the producer already uses ("Write tags to file", "Half-time").
5. Leave the audio file where the producer saved it.

Don't:

1. Don't put developer notes, TODOs, or lorem in the window.
2. Don't use a light theme for v1. `color-scheme: dark` is set.

3. Don't recolor status dots without updating this table.
4. Don't add a second accent that competes with gold.
5. Don't watermark the cover image unless the owner asks. The producer name is a tag, not a stamp.
6. Don't replace IBM Plex with a font whose license forbids embedding in a sold app.

15. Screens

The running window was captured during development. Images are pull-request artifacts, not committed PNGs:

- Library and analysis: Night Drive selected, BPM 140.25, F# minor, half-time and double-time controls visible.
- Metadata and artwork: cover well, title, producer, genre, mood, tags.
- Crop dialog: title "Crop cover", export size 3000×3000, Use cover.

Annotated notes: the tempo figure is `.tempo` at 40px mono. The Camelot code sits in `.camelot`. The primary action in the inspector is "Write tags to file". The crop primary action is "Use cover".

16. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Gold	`#e4b15a`, the only brand accent.
Ink	`#1a1408`, text on gold buttons.
Faint	`#938d85`, metadata labels.

17. Open questions

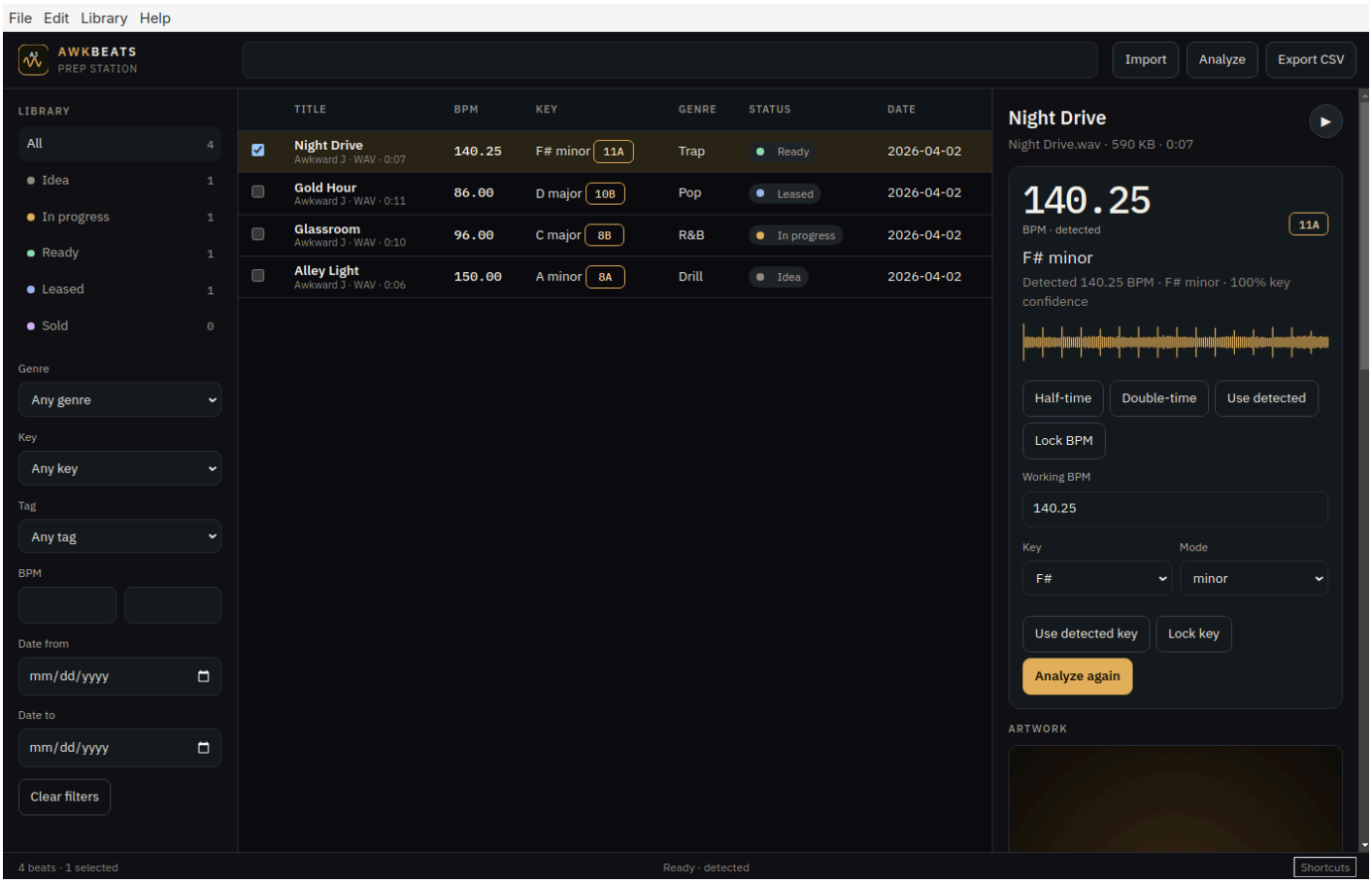
ID	Question	Owner	Blocked
Q-004	Approve or replace the drawn AJ mark	Awkward J	Final brand
Q-010	Is a wordmark lockup needed beyond the top bar?	Awkward J	Marketing site, not this app

18. Changelog

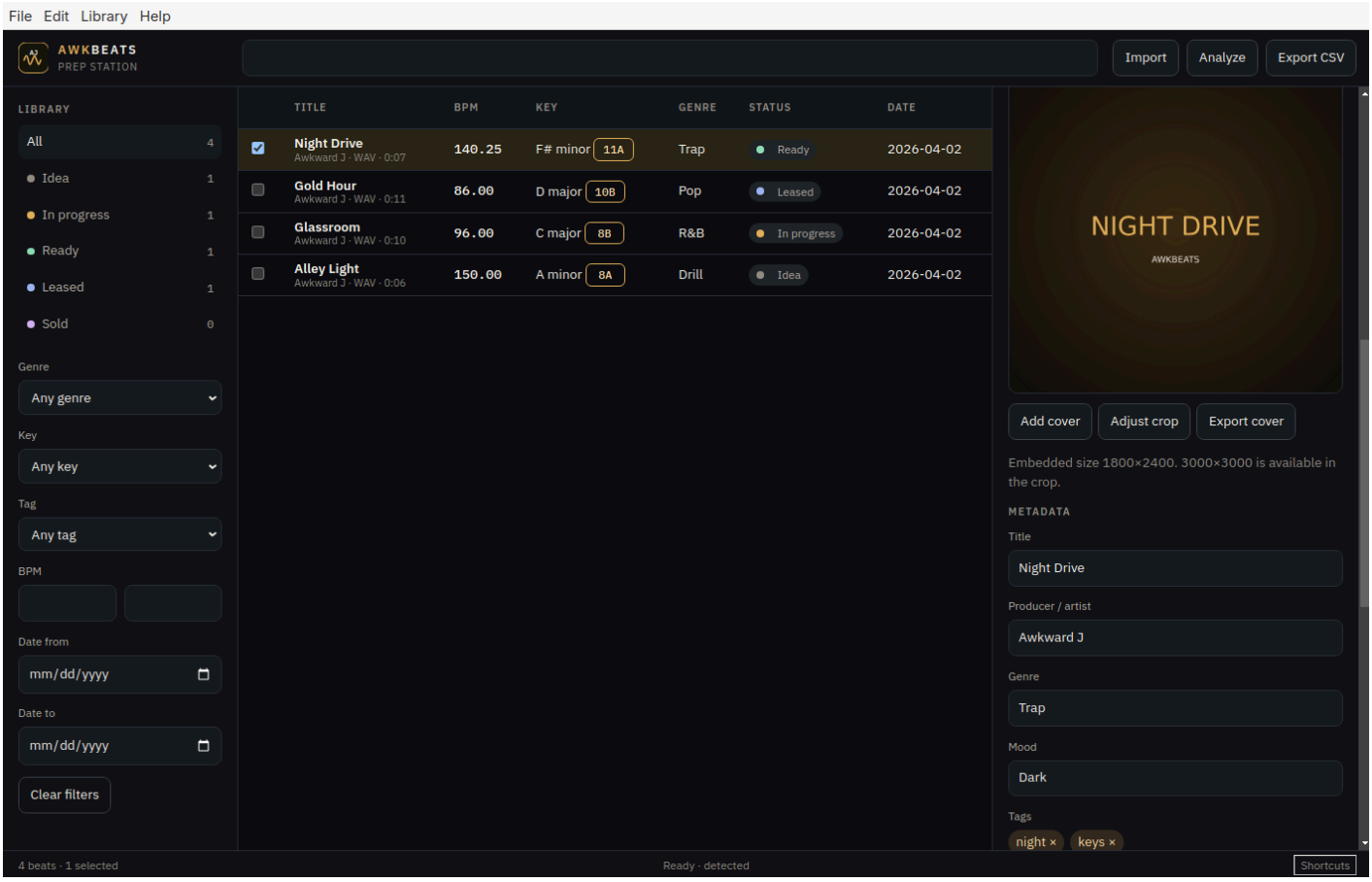
Date	Version	Change	Why
2026-10-21	1.0	Brief matched to `styles.css`, including the faint-color contrast fix.	Owner build brief. `#7e786e` failed AA for 11px labels.

19. Sources

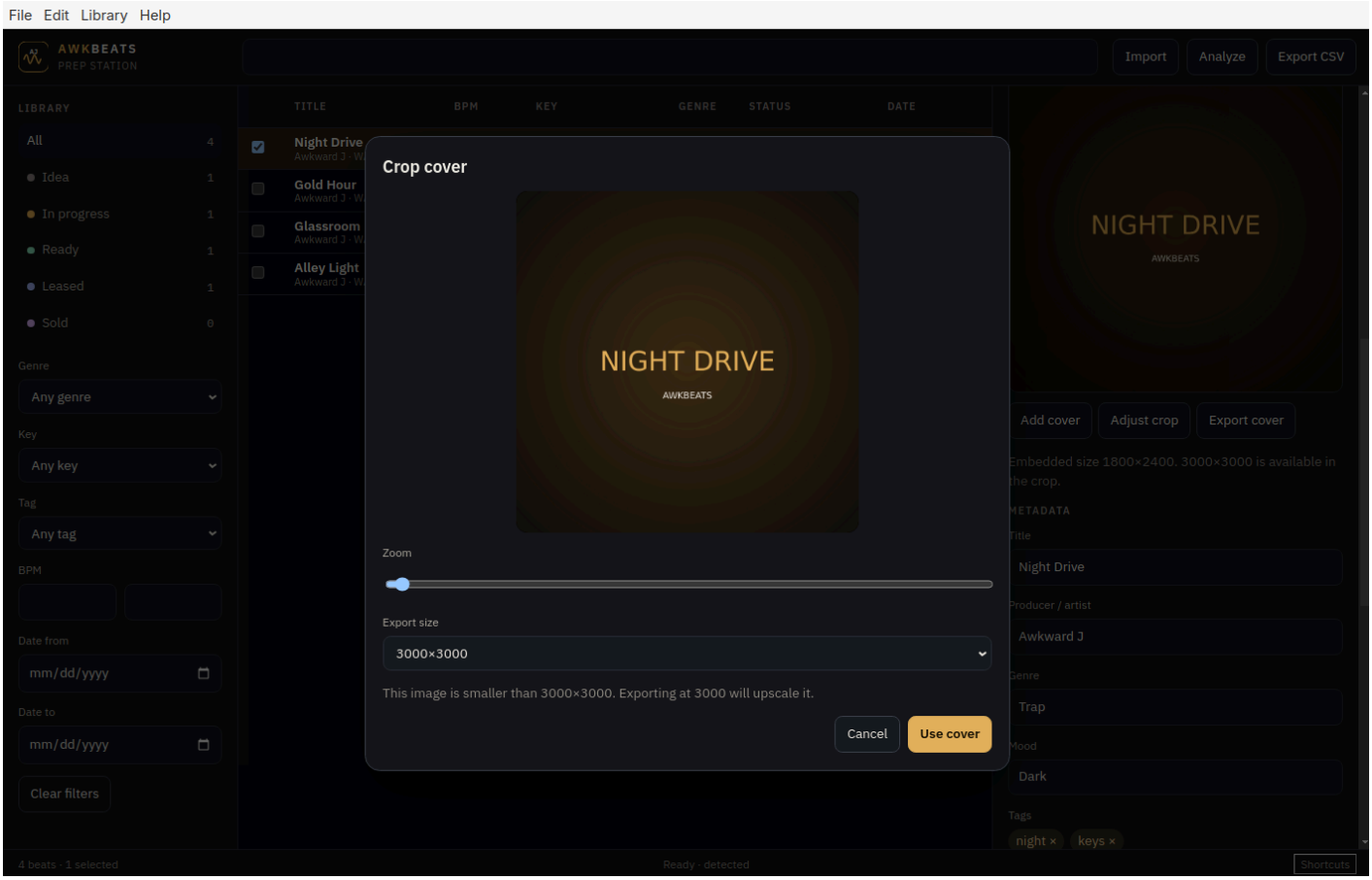
- `src/renderer/styles.css`, `main.tsx`, `App.tsx`, `Inspector.tsx`, `dialogs.tsx`.
- `build/icon.svg`, `build/icon.png`, `build/icon.ico`.
- Contrast script run locally on 2026-10-21 (WCAG relative luminance).
- `@fontsource/ibm-plex-sans` and `@fontsource/ibm-plex-mono` license: SIL OFL 1.1.



Library and analysis. Night Drive selected, BPM and key visible.



Metadata and artwork editor.



Crop cover dialog with a 3000 export size.